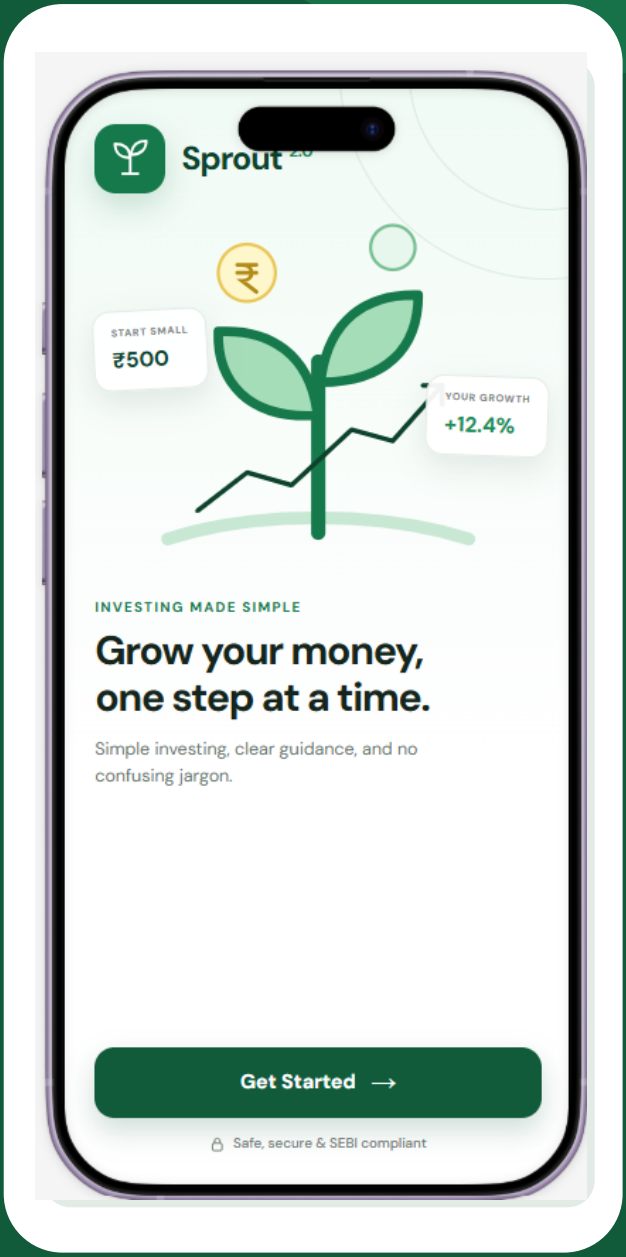
UI/UX DESIGN ASSIGNMENT | CASE STUDY

Sprout 2.0

Designing a calmer first step into investing for beginners

A mobile-first fintech concept that turns onboarding into a short, friendly, jargon-free journey.



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October 2026

Prototype built in Figma Make

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01 THE BRIEF

Project Overview

Sprout 2.0 is a mobile-first fintech app concept that helps first-time investors in India get started. The assignment focused on the full first-run experience: from the welcome screen to a personalised dashboard. The goal was to make a high-stakes, jargon-heavy domain feel simple and safe.

Project type

UI/UX design assignment. Mobile app concept, onboarding plus home dashboard.

Platform

Mobile (iOS-style frame, ~390 px wide). Designed for one-handed use.

Tools

Figma Make for the interactive prototype. GitHub for the repository and screenshots.

Scope of the design

- Welcome - sets the tone and one clear call to action.
- Create account - name, email, phone (step 1 of 4).
- OTP verification - simulated, step 2 of 4 (demo mode).
- Personal details - date of birth, occupation, income (step 3 of 4).
- KYC demonstration - simulated identity check (step 4 of 4).
- Success + Dashboard - confirmation, then sample portfolio, quick actions, growth chart.

Important note on what is real

OTP verification and KYC are simulated for demonstration. No real SMS or identity verification is performed, no real PAN details are collected, and all investment values and returns on the dashboard are sample data.

My role

Solo project. I handled research framing, user flow, visual design system, screen design, copywriting, and prototype build.

Design process

Understand | Define | Map flow | Design UI | Prototype | Review

02 WHY THIS MATTERS

The Problem

Many first-time investors never start. Not because they lack money, but because the first screens feel intimidating: unfamiliar terms, long forms, and unclear reasons for asking for personal data.

How might we help a beginner feel confident and in control during their first five minutes with an investing app?

Pain points I designed against

Jargon overload

Terms like NAV, SIP and folio put beginners off before they begin.

Form fatigue

Long sign-up forms feel like work and cause drop-off.

Trust gap

People hesitate to share identity details if the reason is unclear.

No sense of progress

Without visible steps, users cannot tell how much is left.

Fear of big money

Beginners worry they need a lot to start.

Empty first screen

A blank dashboard gives no picture of what the app will do.

These pain points are my working assumptions, drawn from common patterns in consumer fintech onboarding and informal observation, not from a formal study. See "Next steps" for how I would validate them.

The opportunity

Treat onboarding as the product's first lesson. If every screen is short, explains itself and shows progress, a beginner reaches the dashboard feeling capable instead of confused. That feeling is what turns a sign-up into a first investment.

03 WHO I DESIGNED FOR

Target User

AS

Ananya Sharma

Persona (assumed) | 24, early-career professional

Just started her first job and wants her savings to do more than sit in an account. She uses UPI daily, is comfortable with apps, but has never invested and does not know where to begin.

GOALS

- Start with a small amount
- Understand what she is buying
- Feel safe sharing details

FRUSTRATIONS

- Finance apps feel built for experts
- Unclear why data is requested
- Fear of making a costly mistake

What this means for the design

Lower the barrier

Show a small starting amount (₹ 500) on the very first screen.

Explain every ask

Each form has a short line saying why we need the information.

Show the road

A 4-step progress bar and plain, friendly headings throughout.

Secondary users: students making a first investment from pocket money, and family members who want to try a simple app before moving savings from traditional options.

Scenario

Ananya hears about investing from a colleague over lunch. That evening she opens Sprout on her phone. She sees that she can begin with just ₹500, fills in three simple fields, picks her occupation and income from a list, completes a clearly explained identity step, and lands on a dashboard that shows what her money could look like. The whole journey takes a few minutes and she never has to look up a word.

04 STRATEGY

Design Goals & Principles

Four principles guided every screen. When a decision was unclear, I asked which option best honoured these.

1

Simple over clever

One idea per screen, one primary button, generous white space.

2

Friendly, not formal

Plain words and an encouraging voice: "Grow your money, one step at a time."

3

Transparent by default

Say why data is needed. Label demo content as demo.

4

Show progress

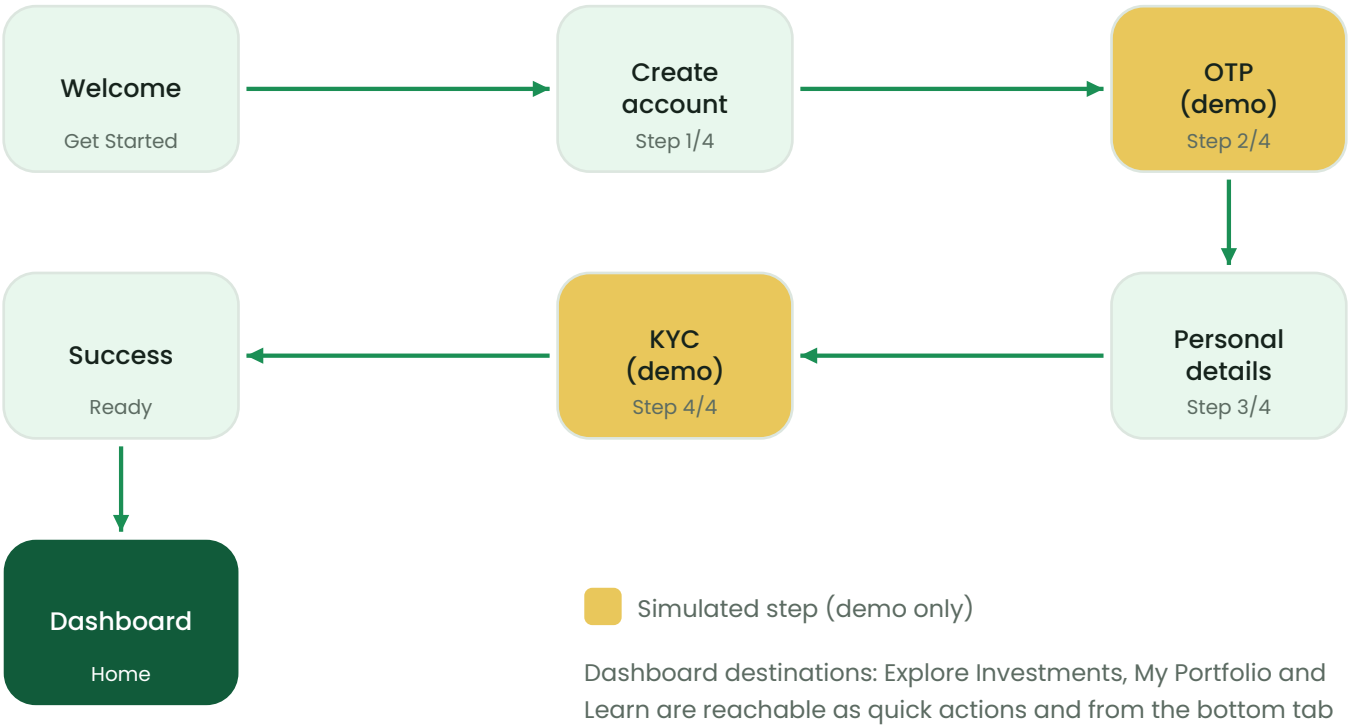
Step counters and a progress bar so users always know where they are.

Success looks like

- A new user completes onboarding without needing help or leaving to search a term.
- The user understands why each piece of information is requested.
- The dashboard gives an immediate, readable picture of what the app offers.

User Flow

The journey is a single linear path with no dead ends. Each step has one forward action and a back arrow.



Dashboard destinations: Explore Investments, My Portfolio and Learn are reachable as quick actions and from the bottom tab bar (Home, Portfolio, Learn, Profile).

Flow decisions

- Only 3 fields per form page. Account details and personal details are split to keep each screen short.
- Personal details come before KYC so the user feels invested before the sensitive step.
- Back arrow on every inner screen so no step feels like a commitment.

Visual Design System

A growth metaphor drives the visual language: a sprout, soft greens and a single warm accent. The result should feel fresh and trustworthy, not like a trading terminal.

Colour palette

Forest
#115B3A
Primary buttons, headings

Leaf
#1B8F55
Accents, progress, positive

Mint
#E8F7ED
Soft backgrounds, tags

Gold
#E9C75B
Coin / highlight

Ink
#16231C
Body text

Typography

Grow your money

LABELS | Medium, small caps style, widely spaced

Body copy: regular weight, short lines, high contrast on white.

A friendly geometric sans-serif across the app. Bold for headlines, medium for labels, regular for body. Large headlines create a clear entry point on each screen.

Core components



Primary button, full width



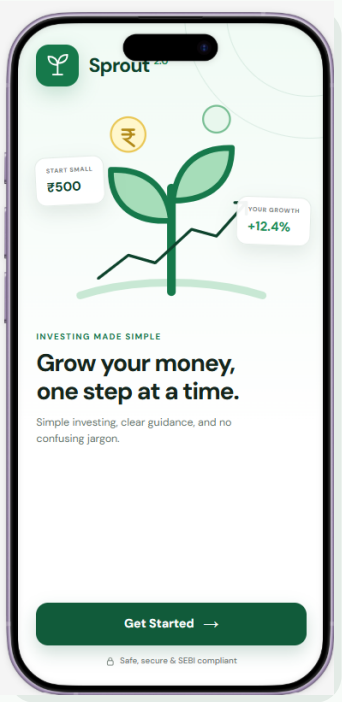
Input with focus state



Gradient value card

Rounded corners (12-24 px), soft shadows and a consistent 4-step progress bar keep the experience cohesive from first screen to dashboard.

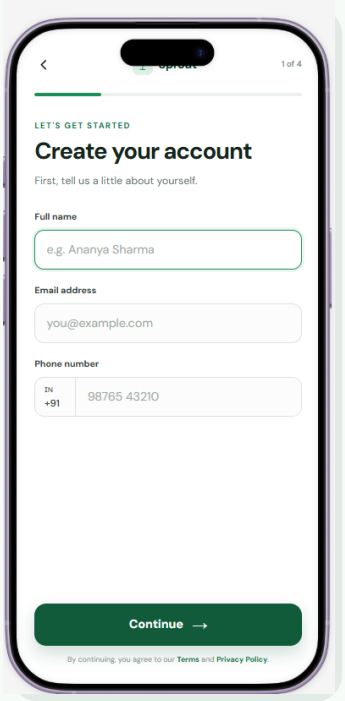
Screen Walkthrough: Getting Started



Welcome

The first impression: one message, one action

- **A** Sprout illustration makes investing feel gentle and approachable.
- **B** "Start small ₹500" chip removes the fear of needing a lot of money.
- **C** Plain-language headline and a one-line promise with no jargon.
- **D** A single call to action, with a trust line directly beneath it.



Create account

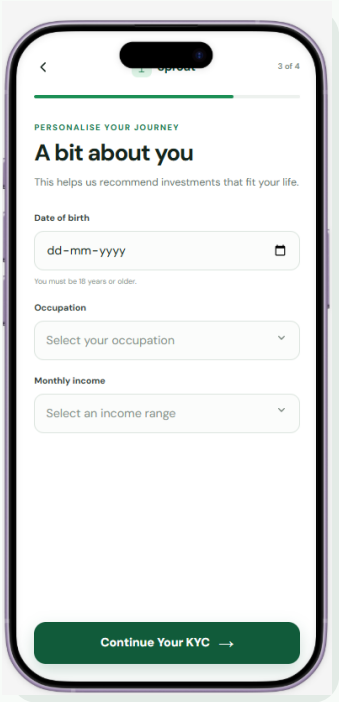
Step 1 of 4: three fields, nothing else

- **A** Progress bar and "1 of 4" counter show how much is left.
- **B** Example placeholders (e.g. Ananya Sharma) show the expected format.
- **C** The +91 prefix is pre-set for the Indian market.
- **D** Terms and Privacy are shown at the point of commitment.

Why it works

- One decision on the welcome screen: tap "Get Started".
- Fields are ordered from least to most personal, and the active field is highlighted green.
- The primary action is pinned at the bottom, within thumb reach.

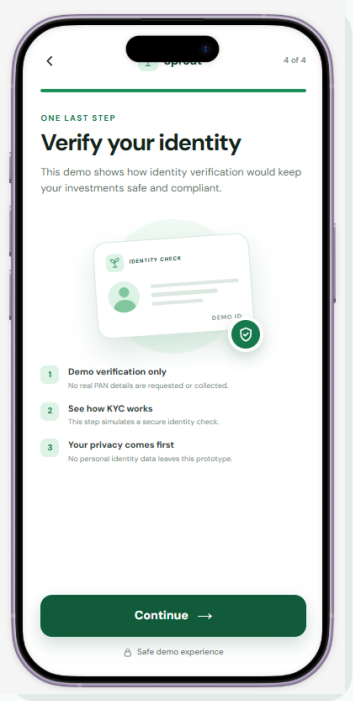
Screen Walkthrough: Personalise & Verify



A bit about you

Step 3 of 4: personalisation with a stated purpose

- **A** Subtitle explains why we ask: it helps recommend investments that fit.
- **B** Date picker with a hint: "You must be 18 years or older."
- **C** Dropdowns for occupation and income are faster than typing.
- **D** Button label "Continue Your KYC" prepares the user for what is next.



Verify your identity

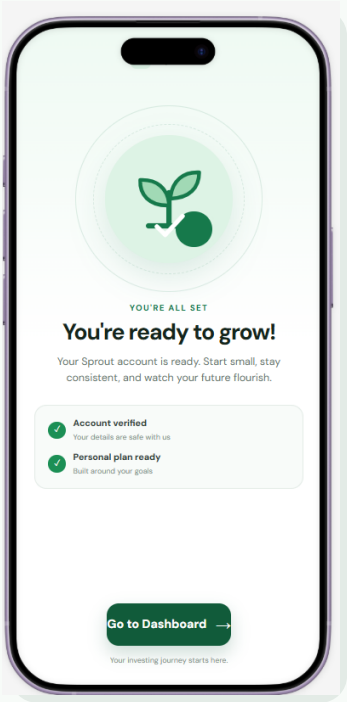
Step 4 of 4: honest, demo-labelled KYC

- **A** Full progress bar and "One last step" signal the finish line.
- **B** Identity-card illustration is clearly marked "Demo ID".
- **C** Three numbered points explain what happens and what does not.
- **D** "Safe demo experience" reassures the user under the button.

Why it works

- Selecting from lists is faster and less error-prone on mobile.
- KYC is framed as a safety benefit, not paperwork, and the demo disclaimer is visible without alarming.
- No real PAN or identity data is requested anywhere in the prototype.

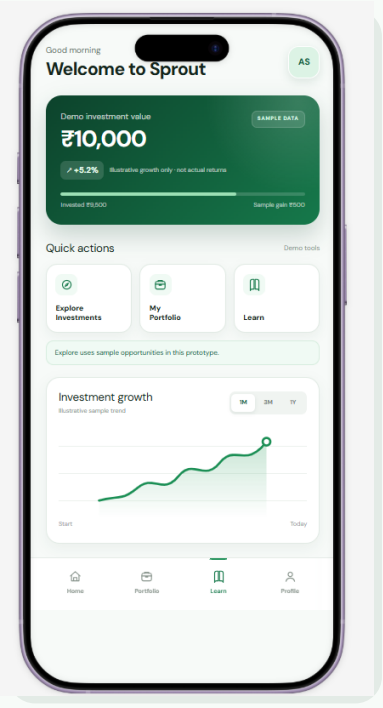
Screen Walkthrough: Success & Dashboard



You're ready to grow!

A short moment of celebration

- **A** Large sprout-and-check emblem confirms success visually.
- **B** Two checkmarks summarise what was completed.
- **C** One clear CTA, "Go to Dashboard", moves the user forward.



Dashboard

Sample data to show the product vision

- **A** Greeting and avatar initials give a personal feel.
- **B** Value card carries a "Sample data" badge and "not actual returns" note.
- **C** Quick actions: Explore Investments, My Portfolio, Learn.
- **D** Growth chart with 1M / 3M / 1Y toggle, labelled illustrative.

Why it works

- The success screen closes the loop with positive emotional feedback.
- The dashboard is never empty: sample data shows what a funded account would feel like.
- Everything that is not real is labelled, so the demo stays honest.

10 WHAT I WOULD IMPROVE

Design Decisions & Self-Critique

Key decisions

Split sign-up into two short forms	Reduces perceived effort and gives two progress milestones.
Pin the CTA to the bottom	Consistent thumb-friendly position on every screen.
Label all demo content	Keeps the prototype honest and builds trust.
Use sample data on dashboard	Lets reviewers see the intended end state.

Self-critique: issues I found in my own prototype

Reviewing the final screens, I spotted several things I would fix in the next iteration:

- Tab bar state. On the Home dashboard, the highlighted tab is "Learn". The active indicator should follow the current screen.
- Trust copy. The welcome screen says "SEBI compliant". For a prototype this should be rephrased (for example "Designed with SEBI guidelines in mind") to avoid implying a real regulatory claim.
- Success wording. "Account verified" appears after a simulated KYC. In a demo it should read "Demo account ready" to stay consistent with the disclaimers.
- Button padding. On the success screen the "Go to Dashboard" label sits tight against the button edges; it needs more horizontal padding.
- Header logo. On inner screens the Sprout logo in the header is partly covered by the device notch area. Move the brand mark or shift content below the safe area.
- Accessibility. Small grey helper text (e.g. "You must be 18 years or older") should be tested against WCAG contrast and enlarged slightly.

11 WRAPPING UP

Outcomes, Learnings & Next Steps

What I delivered

- A complete 7-screen onboarding and dashboard flow, built as an interactive prototype.
- A consistent design system: colour, type, components and a 4-step progress pattern.
- A transparent demo approach for OTP, KYC and all portfolio data.

What I learned

- Trust in fintech is built through small details: explaining why data is needed and labelling what is simulated.
- Fewer fields per screen matters more than fewer screens.
- A final review pass finds real issues (see page 11). Testing with real users would find more.

Next steps

1. Fix the issues

Resolve the tab-bar state, trust wording, and spacing items listed on page 11.

2. Test with users

Run 5 usability sessions with first-time investors and measure task completion and confusion points.

3. Build out Explore

Design sample investment detail pages and plain-language "Learn" content.

PROJECT LINKS

GitHub: github.com/SamradhSingh28/Sprout2-UIUX-Assignment

Figma Make prototype: linked from the repository README

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